

the richness of Access Control Entry encoding for Subjects, significant care has to be taken to avoid incorrectly rejecting an incoming [CASE](#) session establishment that could be valid. Rejecting valid connections could cause a Node to become unreachable. Any constraints on transport-level and network-level functionality, including but not limited to the availability of commissioning-mode connectivity, are out of Access Control scope.

6.6.2.5. Incoming Subject Descriptors

The Message Layer SHALL provide sufficient metadata (e.g. Authentication Mode, source identity) about incoming messages to the Interaction Model protocol layer in order to properly enforce Access Control.

An Incoming Subject Descriptor (ISD) is a mapping from the security layer fields of an incoming Message to a tuple of [AuthMode](#), [SubjectDescriptor](#) that can map unambiguously to an Access Control Entry's [Subjects](#) and [AuthMode](#) fields. See [Section 6.6.6.1.3, "Incoming Subject Descriptor \(ISD\) Structure"](#) for further details.

6.6.2.6. Access Control Extensions

An implementation MAY use [Access Control Extensions](#) to extend the base Access Control model. Since all extensions are installed by Administrators for a fabric, it is expected that only extensions that would improve overall security will be applied. Since every Vendor MAY implement extensions as they see fit, it SHOULD NOT be expected that an extension will be supported by every Node. It is therefore RECOMMENDED that careful consideration of interoperability concerns be given when implementing Access Control Extensions. A fabric's Administrators MAY always read a given Node's Access Control Entries and Access Control Extensions pertaining to the fabric. Therefore, Administrators MAY use extensions to record auditing metadata about Access Control Entries which are not for operational use by the Node.

A Node SHALL preserve every field of the installed Access Control Cluster, including extensions when present, without internally-initiated modifications, so that they may be read-back verbatim upon receiving an appropriate request from an Administrator.

6.6.2.7. Application-level Permissions

The Access Control Cluster SHALL NOT be used to encode application-level permissions and configurations such as smart lock PIN codes or similar user-facing security functionality. Application-level security is best served by finer-grained capabilities described and addressed by application-domain-specific clusters.

6.6.2.8. Access Restrictions

An Access Control Entry in the ACL describes permissions granted by the fabric Administrator. In contrast, an Access Restriction Entry in the ARL describes restrictions imposed by the device. The ARL restrictions override permissions granted in the ACL.

6.6.2.9. Bootstrapping of the Access Control Cluster

Updates to the Access Control List through Access Control Cluster attributes and commands SHALL be restricted by the same Access Control mechanisms as all other clusters on the Node, and there-